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Website: https://alexandernwala.com/
Research Lab: NEWS Lab
Github: https://github.com/anwala
Google Scholar: Citations: 271, h-index: 9 (at 2026-11-03)
Updated 2026-11-03 (Self)

Dr. Alexander C. Nwala

Research interests

Social Media/Computational Social Science, Web/Data Science
Web Archiving, (Local)News, NLP

Education

2020 – 2022 **Postdoctoral**, *Observatory on Social Media, Indiana University, Bloomington, Indiana*, USA
Advisor: Filippo Menczer

2014 – 2020 **Ph.D. Computer Science**, *Old Dominion University (ODU), Norfolk, Virginia*, USA
Thesis: Bootstrapping Web Archive Collections From Micro-Collections In Social Media,
Summa Cum Laude, Advisor: Michael Nelson

2012 – 2014 **M.S. Computer Science**, *Old Dominion University, Norfolk, Virginia*, USA
Thesis: Generating Combinatorial Objects - A New Perspective,
Summa Cum Laude, Advisor: Stephan Olariu

2008 – 2011 **B.S. Computer Science (Minor: Aviation Science)**, *Elizabeth City State University, Elizabeth City, North Carolina*, USA
Summa Cum Laude

Academic Appointments

08/2022 – Present **Assistant Professor, William & Mary, Williamsburg Virginia**
08/2020 – 07/2022 **Postdoctoral Researcher, Observatory on Social Media, Indiana University**

Teaching

William & Mary

Key: U **- Undergraduate,** G **- Graduate,** N **- New,** D **- Designed,** R **- Restructured**

Spring/Fall 2026 **Reasoning with GenAI - DATA 101**^{UR}
Fall 2024 **Ethics in Data Science - DATA 202-01**^{UR}
Spring 2024 **Network Analysis - DATA 641-01**^{GND}**/445-01**^{UND}
Spring 2023 **Network Science - DATA 340-02**^{UND}
Fall 2022/2023/2024 **Web Science - DATA 691-03**^{GN}**/440-{02,03,07}**^{UN}

Old Dominion University

Spring 2018/2019 **Web Science - CS 432**^{U}**/532**^{G}
July - November 2018 **Introduction to Programming with C++ - CS 150**
Volunteer C++ Instructor for Middle/High School Students (ages 11 - 16)
Fall 2014, Spring/Fall 2015 **Programming and Problem Solving in C++ - CS 333/CS 250**
Teaching Assistant/Lab Instructor

Advising at William & Mary

Undergraduate

- **Major Advisor:** Fall 2026: 15 students, Spring 2026: 11 students, Fall 2025: 12 students, Spring 2025: 17 students, Fall 2024: 17 students, Spring 2024: 3 students, Fall 2023: 2 students, and Spring 2023: 2 students.
- **Primary advisor for Honors' thesis:** Fall 2022 – Spring 2023: Metzger Zoe (Identifying Social Media Users that are Susceptible to Phishing Attacks)

- **Honors' committee member:** Fall 2023: Seggelke Kayla and Larimer Sarah. Spring 2024: Crowley Kaitlyn.
- **Primary advisor for Monroe scholar:** 2024: Kim Hannah (How do makeup trends propagate and evolve across TikTok)
- **Undergraduate research group members:** 2022: Nelson Ethan and Huang Sofia 2023: Swack Jeremy, Nelson Ethan, and McDonalds Ian. 2024: McDonalds Ian and Emmanuel-King Greatness.

Graduate
- **Current PhD Students:** Ariyarathne Gangani, Ariyarathne Isuru, Sahan Jayasinghe

Software/Services

- agwagram: Social media behavior explorer
- Coordiscope: Inauthentic coordination explorer
- BLOC: Social media user behavior model
- Sumgram: Text collection summarization with most frequent conjoined ngrams
- StoryGraph: Real-time news Story Link Detection (Twitter Bot, Github)
- Local Memory Project: US/non-US local news media sources

Grants ($980K total, Awarded: 6, PI: 4, External: 3)

2026 (Awarded $750K): IMLS: CiteCast: Linking US local & national television news to cited web resources
2026 (Awarded $80K): COVA CCI: Securing Agentic AI Systems using Verified Behavioral Templates
2023 – 2026 (Awarded $175K): NSF CRII: III: Measuring the alignment between the interests of local communities, local news, and the national news media
2022 – 2024 (Awarded $10K): W&M Faculty Research Grants
2022 – 2023 (Awarded Co-PI, $5K): W&M Arts and Science Dean's Faculty Support

Service

William & Mary
- **CDSP (2026 -):** Data Science representative in Committee on Undergraduate Studies
- **University (2024 - 2025):** Quality Enhancement Plan Committee (QEP - Infrastructure Working Group), Vice Provost for Enrollment Strategy search committee, and Camp Launch (Focusing on the Future) Mentor.
- **Data Science Committees:** 2024: Curriculum committee member. 2022 – 2023: Nominations and awards committee, Search committee for Assistant/Associate/Professor of Data Science and Director of the CGA.
- **Recommender:** 2022: Ethan Nelson (grad. school) and Sofia Huang (grad. school). 2023: Suditi Shyamsunder (Botetourt award) and Sampath Jayarathna (Tenure). 2024: Gangani Ariyarathne (NSF travel award)
- **Co-lab instructor (Fall 2023/2024):** Anthologies-Canons; ENGL 480-01 (Primary Instructor: Arthur Knight)
- **Collaborators:** 2026: Dr. Yi He (WikiTrace), Dr. Trenton Ford (Community-News Alignment), and Dr. Yanfu Zhang (IMLS). 2023 – 2024: Arthur Knight - co-instructed Anthologies Lab and instructed W&M students to develop tool to automate data entry. Collaborated on Network Science course group project based on Dr. Knight's research interest. 2024 – present: Jaime Settle - collaborating on NSF HNDS-I grant. James Alcorn (Director of the Election Law Program at W&M Law School) - collaborating on developing machine-learning models to classify election law legal documents.

Extramural
- **Journal Editor (2024 – Present):** PeerJ, Computer Science
- **PC Member/Peer reviewer (2020 – Present):** ACM/IEEE Joint Conference on Digital Libraries (JCDL), ACM Web Science
- **NSF proposal reviewer (2023):** NSF CISE
- **PC Member/Peer reviewer (2023):** iPRES2023, EPJ Data Science, TheWebConf2023-Companion (CySoc 2023)
- **Tutorial/Workshop/Conference session Chair (2021/2023):** ACM/IEEE JCDL
- **Journal Reviewer (2020):** PLoS ONE
- **Collaborators:** 2023 – present: Fil Menczer and OSoMe (Indiana University) - collaborated to develop coordiscope and Information Operations dataset. 2024 – present: Michael Nelson and Michele Weigle (Old Dominion University) - collaborating on NSF HNDS-I grant. Faryaneh Poursardar (Old Dominion University) - collaborating on Minerva (DoD) grant.